Walter Kettenhofen Leon

Game Developer — Gameplay & Systems Programming

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SUMMARY

Gameplay programmer with **5 years shipping 14 commercial titles across three hardware platforms**, in both a proprietary C++ engine and Unity. Own features end to end — core gameplay, event-driven systems, hardware input, rendering, animation, and shaders — and build with AI-assisted development workflows to move faster without giving up control of the architecture. Trilingual: Spanish, English, German.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: C#, C++, Lua, JavaScript

Engines & Graphics: Unity (URP/HDRP), Shader Graph, ProBuilder, proprietary in-house engine (MForce), Roblox

Gameplay: Event-driven architecture, state machines, hardware input handling, hit detection, game AI, pathfinding, object pooling, procedural generation

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, agentic coding workflows, AI-assisted refactoring, debugging, and editor tooling

Tools & Process: Perforce, Git, Unity Profiler, Visual Studio, Jira, Agile, code reviews

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Game Developer

February 2026 – Present · Las Vegas, NV

- Building **Ultimate Chicken Lord** in Unity (C#) — procedurally generated island terrain, AI-driven creature behavior, and a runtime save system that persists correctly in standalone builds, not just in the editor.
- Work with **Claude Code as a daily development partner**: scaffolding Unity editor tooling, prototyping gameplay systems, and tracing runtime bugs across scenes and prefabs. Own the architecture and review every generated change like a teammate's pull request — fast iteration without giving up ownership of the codebase.
- Maintain a released and in-development catalog on itch.io across Windows, macOS, and Android.

Software Developer — IGT / Everi Holdings

March 2021 – February 2026 · Las Vegas, NV

- Shipped **14 commercial titles across 3 cabinet platforms**, owning each from core gameplay and feature logic through animation integration, rendering, and certification-ready release — built in a proprietary C++ engine (MForce) and Unity.
- **First developer at the studio to target the Player Classic Signature cabinet**, establishing the rendering and integration patterns later titles built on.
- Cut GPU utilization on Pop-A-Shot® from **90% to 70%** by restructuring animation and rendering code, recovering headroom within the cabinet's fixed hardware budget.
- Lead gameplay programmer on **Skee-Ball®** and **Pop-A-Shot®**, licensed-brand titles built on real-time skill mechanics rather than standard reel logic: designed the event-driven gameplay systems, hit detection, and the bonus-level random light sequence, and programmed the **physical button panel firmware and input handling** end to end.
- Authored shaders and visual effects in Unity Shader Graph and integrated animation and art assets with technical artists to hit the intended visual target on hardware.
- Delivered production code for regulated markets, balancing gameplay ambition against stability, certification, and compliance constraints.
- Worked in **cross-functional teams of ~10** — visual artists, technical artists, designers, audio, producers, math, and QA — through Agile iteration and code reviews.

  Selected titles: Skee-Ball®, Pop-A-Shot®, Smokin' Gems Signature™, Star Jewels Signature™, Wild Rooster, Dragon's Luck, Blue Ribbon™, Double Jackpot 777 — plus six additional titles and supporting work on Cash Machine Haywire and Pop Pays Cherry Bomb.

Game Developer (Roblox) — Gamer's Clan
2020 – 2021 · 6 months

- Built multiplayer gameplay systems and features in Lua on Roblox, including player mechanics, UI functionality, and core game logic.
- Optimized scripts for performance and scalability, and iterated on features with designers and artists through playtesting.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Ultimate Chicken Lord — Unity, C# · *playable, in development*
3D island adventure: procedurally generated terrain, AI-driven creatures, race and sumo minigames, fishing, and a save system that persists in standalone builds.
waltzilla.itch.io/ultimate-chicken-lord

The Rock Hunter — Unity, C# · *released, Windows/macOS*
Asteroids-style arcade shooter. Built an object pooling system to spawn and recycle asteroids without runtime allocation, plus the player ship's input handling and movement controls.

Bouncy Arcade — Unity, C# · *in development, Windows/Android*
Experimental physics game where the player controls a blob that collides with spaceships. Sole programmer — shaders, AI, rendering, and all technical systems.

LStudy — Unity, C# · *in development, Windows/Android*
Educational application built as the thesis project for my degree.

Full portfolio: waltzilla.itch.io

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree, Video Game Programming — SAE Institute, validated by Middlesex University
2019 – 2021

LANGUAGES

Spanish (Native) · English (Native) · German (Fluent)